

1 Getting started



OpenSolaris is the binary distribution of a mature, free and open source operating system, based around Sun Microsystems' Solaris operating system. The history of OpenSolaris begins in 1983 (27 years ago!) when Sun released its own flavour of Unix named SunOS 1.0. In June 1992, SunOS was renamed Solaris. With millions of installations all around the globe, Solaris is one of the most popular flavours of Unix in the world and is known for its scalability, security and stability. In 2005, Sun decided to open source the code base of Solaris and as the result of it, OpenSolaris was born. OpenSolaris is available for the x86 platform as well as the SPARC platform. Both 32-bit and 64-bit versions are available and can be downloaded from <http://www.opensolaris.com>.

1.1 Getting familiar

Like every other popular operating system, OpenSolaris has a GUI, which is based on GNOME. Thousands of applications, including the most popular open source applications Firefox, OpenOffice and Thunderbird have been ported to OpenSolaris. OpenSolaris is distributed under the Common Development and Distribution License (CDDL), which is a variant of the Mozilla licence used by Firefox. Because many applications, including the GNOME desktop environment, are common with various Linux distributions, you can confuse OpenSolaris to be yet another Linux distribution. However, OpenSolaris is not Linux! There are many unique features available on OpenSolaris that sets it apart from all the other operating systems such as Linux and Windows.

The term *OpenSolaris* can also have other meanings to depending on the context it is used. *OpenSolaris* is used to refer to:

- An operating system code base that is originally based on Sun's proprietary Solaris operating system.